

Best Teacher Award 2026

BEST TEACHER AWARD 2026

GITAM (Deemed to be University) will continue its tradition of recognizing outstanding faculty members through the "Best Teacher Award." This award honours meritorious teachers for their exceptional teaching, hard work, and dedication to their craft during the Academic Year 2025-26.

Purpose of the Award:

The Best Teacher Award seeks to promote excellence in teaching by recognizing faculty members who demonstrate outstanding classroom practice, meaningful student support, and significant contributions to teaching and learning at the University.

Award Details:

- **Award Ceremony:** This award will be presented on Teacher's Day
- **Number of awards:** One award per School per Campus
- **Award Components:**
 - A cheque for Rs. 1,00,000/-
 - A citation recognizing the recipient's achievements

Selection Process:

The selection procedure will follow a two-stage process:

- Stage I – Initial shortlisting of candidates
- Stage II – Final selection of awardees from the shortlisted candidates

The shortlisting and final selection will be done by a School-level Shortlisting and Selection Committee of the respective campus, comprising:

- Dean – Member and Chairperson
- Head of Institute (HoI) – Member and Convenor
- Heads of Department (HoDs) – Members

For Stage II, it is advised that the Dean nominate one staff member from outside their School to serve as a member of the Shortlisting and Selection Committee for the final selection process.

A Committee member shall not participate in the evaluation of a candidate where a conflict of interest exists.

Eligibility Criteria for the Nominated Teacher:

- The teacher must have completed the probation period and been confirmed in service before the start of the Academic Year 2025-26
- The teacher must be a full-time faculty member and actively engaged in teaching work at the time of

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application for the award

- The teacher should not have any disciplinary issues or a history of misconduct
- The teacher should not have been a recipient of the award in the immediate previous year
- The teacher cannot be a member of the Shortlisting and Selection Committee

Nomination Details:

- Faculty members may apply directly or be nominated by another full-time faculty member
- Nomination by members of the Shortlisting and Selection Committee is not allowed

How to Apply:

Faculty members should log in to their My-GITAM portal, navigate to G-Staff, and click on the Best Teacher icon to complete and submit the application.

For Stage I, faculty members or nominators must submit a reflective statement (*maximum 600 words*) describing *innovative pedagogical practices* and *technology-enabled teaching practices* implemented by the nominated teachers in their courses during the Academic Year 2025-26, with special emphasis on the *teaching changes made in response to student feedback*.

Innovation may include active learning, flipped classroom, project-based learning, case-based teaching, simulations, interdisciplinary teaching, AI-enabled learning, experiential learning, inclusive teaching practices, or other evidence-based pedagogical practices.

For Stage II, the shortlisted candidates shall be asked to submit additional evidence, as mentioned in the *Suggested Evaluation Criteria*.

The last date to submit the application is 05 August 2026.

Suggested Evaluation Criteria:

The suggested evaluation criteria listed below are **only indicative**. The Shortlisting and Selection Committee may exercise its academic judgment in evaluating the evidence submitted and may make changes or adopt a different set of evaluation criteria, provided that the principles of fairness, transparency, and consistency are maintained.

For Stage I – Initial shortlisting of candidates:

Category 1: Teaching Excellence

Criterion	Metric	Evidence
Student Feedback	Overall ratings (<i>Feedback will be considered only if it is submitted by at least 30%</i>)	Student feedback data provided by CATS

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	<i>of the students, or else it will be scored zero)</i>	
Academic Innovation	Innovative pedagogical practices implemented	Reflective statement by faculty or nominator.
Usage of Technology	Technology-enabled teaching	Reflective statement by faculty or nominator.
Timeliness	Adherence to academic and evaluation schedules	Timeliness data provided by CATS and DoE

Category 2: Student Support

Criterion	Metric	Evidence
Mentoring	Regularity of meetings conducted with mentees	Mentoring and feedback data provided by GCGC
	Feedback from mentees	

For Stage II – Final selection of awardees from the shortlisted candidates:

Category 1: School Shortlisting and Selection Committee Stage I Score

Category 2: Teaching Excellence

Criterion	Metric	Evidence
Pedagogical Innovation	Innovative pedagogical practices implemented	Lesson plans, classroom activity reports
Usage of Technology	Technology-enabled classroom activities, virtual laboratory/simulation exercises, interactive digital teaching materials	Activity reports, simulation activity reports, link to the material
	Learning analytics used for identifying and supporting at-risk students	Analytics reports, intervention records such as email communications/announcements on the LMS, etc.
Curriculum Development	Creation of new course(s)	Copies of BoS minutes and the approved syllabus
	Revision of existing syllabus (≥20%)	

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Category 3: Student Support

Criterion	Metric	Evidence
Co-Curricular Mentorship	Mentoring students for participating in international competitions, hackathons, innovation challenges, etc.	HoD and HoI endorsement
	Awards/recognition for students because of mentoring	Award certificates
Student Support & Intervention	Academic performance monitoring and interventions to support at-risk students and learners with diverse educational needs	Progress reports, intervention plans and outcomes, alerts sent to the students through email/announcements, etc.
Remedial/Special Classes	Learning resources prepared	Remedial classes plan, study materials
	Student participation	Attendance sheets

Category 4: Contribution to Teaching and Learning at the University

Criterion	Metric	Evidence
Participation in Academic Committees	Leadership role (Chair/Convener)	Appointment order, committee reports, minutes of meetings, and attendance records
	Active committee participation	
Organizing Teaching Events (such as education conferences, FDPs)	Organized conferences	Brochure, poster, and event report
	Conducted teaching-related FDPs, workshops, seminars, and webinars	
	Participant feedback and outcomes	Feedback summary, outcome report